

Carlos Mendieta | Tracing the Roots of Environmental Racism in Houston's Fifth Ward

In the 2023 Pharis Fellowship, Carlos Mendieta conducted a project focused on housing accessibility disparities in Houston in conjunction with environmental pollution exposure. Through utilizing data from the Environmental Protection Agency and the Harris County Appraisal District, he was able to model the market value increase of single family residential property values across Harris County relative to median family income. His project highlights how environmental justice plays a pivotal role in the everyday lives of all communities, with the primary purpose of advocating for health equity of underserved individuals around the city of Houston.

Carlos presented his findings at UH's Undergraduate Research Day in April 2024, and is currently in the process of extending the depth of the project to develop into a manuscript for future publication in environmental and medical health journals.